

APPRAISAL REPORT

Prepared by: Marlowe & Tern Fine Art Valuation (fictional)

Appraiser: Dana Okafor-Lind (fictional)

Client: Private collector (name withheld)

Report number: MT-2291

Date of report: 14 March 2026

1. PURPOSE AND INTENDED USE

This appraisal was prepared to establish a value for insurance scheduling purposes. The intended users are the client and the client's insurer. The report should not be used for any other purpose.

2. BASIS OF VALUE AND EFFECTIVE DATE

The value expressed is Retail Replacement Value, defined as the amount that would be required to replace the item with another of similar age, quality, origin and condition, purchased within a reasonable length of time in the appropriate retail market. The effective date of valuation is 10 March 2026. All figures are in US dollars (USD).

3. DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY

Artist: Elias Varnholt (1887–1952), fictional

Title: Harbour at Dusk

Date: c. 1924

Medium: Oil on canvas

Dimensions: 61 x 76 cm (24 x 30 in), unframed

Signature: Signed lower right "E. Varnholt"

Frame: Later gilt composition frame

The painting depicts a small working harbour at evening, with moored fishing boats in the foreground and warehouse facades lit from within. The palette is dominated by blue-violet and ochre tones characteristic of the artist's mid-1920s coastal series.

4. CONDITION

The appraiser examined the painting in person on 10 March 2026 under natural and ultraviolet light. The canvas has been relined. There is fine, stable craquelure across the sky, and ultraviolet examination shows a small area of retouching in the lower left corner, approximately 3 x 4 cm, in the water. The varnish is slightly discoloured. No active flaking was observed.

5. PROVENANCE

Acquired by the client's family from a regional gallery in 1978; by descent to the present owner. A copy of the 1978 invoice was provided by the client (see Appendix A).

6. MARKET ANALYSIS

Varnholt's coastal scenes from 1922–1927 are the most sought-after period of his output. The market for his work has been stable over the last five years, with occasional strong results for large harbour compositions. The appraiser considered the following sales of comparable works.

Table 1. Comparable sales

#	Title	Date	Medium	Size (cm)	Price basis	Sale date	Price (USD)
C1	Fishing Boats, Evening	1925	Oil on canvas	60 x 73	Auction, hammer price	Oct 2025	42,000
C2	Quay in Rain	1923	Oil on board	46 x 55	Auction, hammer price	May 2024	31,000
C3	The Lighthouse Road	1931	Oil on canvas	81 x 100	Dealer asking price	Jan 2026	68,000
C4	Harbour Lights	1926	Oil on canvas	65 x 81	Auction, incl. buyer's premium	Nov 2021	55,000

7. ADJUSTMENTS

Table 2. Adjusted comparable values

#	Price (USD)	Adjustment	Adjusted value (USD)
C1	42,000	+10% retail uplift	46,200
C2	31,000	+15% canvas vs. board, +10% retail uplift	38,750
C3	68,000	–20% later period and larger size	54,400
C4	55,000	none	55,000

Average of adjusted values: USD 51,600

8. CONCLUSION

Taking into account the subject's quality, its period, and its excellent condition with no restoration, the appraiser concludes that the Retail Replacement Value of the property as at 10 March 2026 is:

USD 58,000 (fifty-eight thousand US dollars)

The subject painting, measuring 76 x 91 cm, is larger than most of the comparables, which supports a value toward the upper end of the range.

9. ASSUMPTIONS AND LIMITING CONDITIONS

- The appraiser has assumed that the attribution to Elias Varnholt is correct. No independent authentication was undertaken.
- The appraiser has relied on the provenance information provided by the client.
- The painting was professionally cleaned in 2019 and is in stable condition, as confirmed in the conservator's report at Appendix B.
- Values are subject to change with market conditions.

10. CERTIFICATION

I certify that I have no present or prospective interest in the property and that my fee is not contingent on the value reported.

APPENDIX A — PROVENANCE DOCUMENTS

Copy of invoice, Harbourside Gallery (fictional), dated 2 August 1978: "E. Varnholt, Harbour at Dusk, oil on canvas, framed".